VON ZAROVICH ESTATE / STATION 5

The Collapsing Armory

Watch your step. Mind your words.

A narrow armory stretches toward a heavy metal door. Eight weapon racks line the walls, each bearing a brass tag etched in an unfamiliar script. Dust hangs between the blades like old cobwebs.

A warning above the entrance catches your eye: “Mind your tongue. The forbidden word is T---.” Beneath it, four letters are scratched out so deeply that the stone has splintered.

Then the ceiling moves.

Iron pistons groan. Long spikes descend by a slow, unmistakable inch. Strange glowing words flicker across the stone above you, too scattered to take in at a glance. A carved gargoyle face peers down from the center of the ceiling.

Directly below it lies a narrow iron drainage grate. Cold, damp air breathes up between the bars. Somewhere below the floor, metal gives a faint clink.

At the far end, a stone mouth is carved into the closed blast door. Its lips remain pressed together. The weapons do not move. The ceiling does.

The room seems to be listening.

Before entering, read silently: the forbidden word is **TRAP**. Saying it, its forms (such as “trapped”), compounds, or spelling it aloud triggers the room. Writing or pointing is allowed. Confirm the rule with the DM before the timer starts.